Run for the Hills

With temperatures soaring and Covid numbers ever likely to rise, the need of this season is to find a private retreat in the hills. Our list of stays, you'll find, is just what the weatherman and doctor ordered

By **Shikha Tripathi**

UTTARAKHAND

RAMGARH

THE WHITE PEAKS

Sitting on the Gagar ridge of Ramgarh, a charming hill town some 52 km away from the Kathgodam railway station, the White Peaks is the labour of love of owners Abhijit and Aparupa Ganguly. The petite two-bedroom cottage comes with a living room, a kitchen, a dining area, and a caretaker who can also cook. A wooden staircase connects the cosy living space to the bedrooms upstairs. The pet-friendly cottage has a grand view of snow-capped peaks on the horizon, which together give the place its name. (Rs 20,000 for four guests, with all meals. thewhitepeaks.com)

DON'T MISS: An hour-long hike up to the Gagar temple will give you a panoramic view of the Kumaon Himalayas.

SOULITUDE IN THE HIMALAYAS

The stellar mountain views do inspire solitude, but one often recommends this luxury space for its plush comfort and the sheer indulgence it affords. Here's a tip: Rent the property's independent five-room cottage. At a distance from the main house, it comes with its own kitchen and dining space, large bedrooms, rooftops with skylights, a private study, a reading lounge, and a private garden. (Rs 46,000 plus taxes with breakfast for the three-bedroom wing. Additional charges for more rooms; soulitude.in)

DON'T MISS: The private outdoor barbecue and dining, organised exclusively for cottage guests.

NAKUCHIATAL

LA BELLE VIEW

Only 30 km away from the Kathgodam railway station, this three-bedroom ivy-covered elfin cottage is located by the still waters of the Naukuchiatal lake and it can, at times, come to seem more dreamy than earthly. Driftwood fashioned into bookshelves, chandeliers in the bathrooms, lofts for kids to sleep in and then there is that enchanting little outdoor garden complete with wrought-iron furniture. Fairy tale enough? (Rs 25,000, inclusive of breakfast and taxes; airbnb.com)

DON'T MISS: Zorbing on the Naukuchiatal lake! For the less adventurous, boating is an option.



ROHIT ANAND

Soulitude in the Himalayas, Ramgarh



La Belle View, Nakuchiatal